



PECAN+ CTF 2026 is almost here

Get competition ready! If you like problem-solving, being challenged or working out technical problems, then this is for you. Tackle cyber security challenges, covering Cryptography, Digital Forensics, OSINT, Web Exploitation, Reverse Engineering and more, in a national competition format

Develop your skills in **Linux basics**, and in the use of basic cyber tools:

- [CyberChef](#) Learn how to use cryptography tools before competition day.
- [CryptoHack](#) Free platform for learning modern cryptography.

Free, online open source cyber training, challenges and CTFs to explore in advance of the competition include:

- [PECAN+ CTF practice challenges](#) A range of previous challenges, for practice.
- [CyLab Academy](#) (previously PicoCTF) Beginner-friendly, free to play all year round.
- [TryHackMe](#) A beginner-friendly platform inc. rooms with guided tutorials. Mostly free (some rooms require premium access).
- [Hack The Box](#) Intermediate platform - hack the site to be able to register! Mostly free (some rooms require premium access).
- [Saburra](#) Free Beginner to Intermediate platform, created by ECU Cyber Security graduate Adam Brickhill.
- [Over The Wire Wargames](#) Categories of challenges, easy progressing to difficult. Categories inc. Linux (Bandit), Web Exploits (Natas) & Cryptography (Krypton).
- [Grahlix](#) Free OSINT exercises

Competition Day: Sunday 23rd August, 2026.

For more information: pecanplus.org

#PECANplus2026



PECAN+ CTF is proudly founded
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Hardware & Software Requirements for PECAN+ CTF 2026

Participants will be encouraged to compete on their own laptops (devices may also be supplied). Any functional laptop with WiFi connectivity should suffice. We have provided recommendations for a suitable configuration of hardware and software. **Don't forget to bring your laptop chargers!**

Hardware suggested requirements:

A laptop is recommended for the PECAN+ CTF Competition.

- Dual Core 2Ghz or Higher (i3/i5/i7 or AMD equivalent processor)
- With a minimum 4 GB RAM

System suggested requirements

- A good internet connection, broadband wired or wireless (preferably 4G connection) with minimum 2.5mbps speed.

Supported operating systems

- macOS X with macOS 10.9 or later
- Windows 10*

Note: For devices running Windows 10, they must run Windows 10 Home, Pro, or Enterprise. S Mode is not supported.

- Windows 8 or 8.1 and above

Supported browsers

- Chrome 66+, Edge 80+, Firefox 58+, Safari 14+

[Copy/Paste from/to Kasm VM using ctrl-c/ctrl-v is only supported on Chrome and Edge. Other browsers have to copy in/out of a text box]

PECAN+ CTF utilises the following platforms:

- CTFd competition site (browser-based)
- Kasm Workspaces VM (browser-based)
- Discord (app/software or browser supported) - you may wish to pre-install.

Other links for practice:

- Get Kali | Kali Linux: [Kali](#)
- Vulnerable By Design: [VulnHub](#)

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Tools for solving CTFs:

Access for competitors to a Virtual Machine of cyber tools (a Kali Linux instance) will be provided via Kasm Workspaces for the 2026 PECAN+ CTF Training and Competition Day.

We encourage you to explore the use of cyber tools and to attempt practice challenges with other freely accessible resources and virtual machines in the lead up to competing (see previous page).

Free VMs and cyber tools for practice can also be accessed through: [Kali](#) or [VulnHub](#).

For your reference, tools in the competition day VM (Kali Linux instance) will likely include:

- kali-linux-default
- torbrowser-launcher
- RSACTFTool
- libgmp3-dev libmpc-dev
- pwntools
- autopsy
- ghidra
- burpsuite
- steghide
- radare2
- hashcat
- binwalk
- wireshark
- gdb gdb-peda
- libimage-exiftool-perl
- ltrace
- gimp
- audacity
- qsstv
- strace
- gfortran
- qemu-system-x86
- jq
- pwndbg
- pypykatz
- stegsolve
- volatility
- AvaloniaLSpy

Additional tools may be added depending on the needs of specific challenges.

We further recommend familiarisation with online tools, such as:

- [Google translate](#)
- [CyberChef](#)
- [Crackstation](#)
- [dCode](#)
- [Google Earth](#)
- [Flightradar24](#)